A RATAN TATA TIMELINE

- **28 December 1937:** Ratan Tata is born to Soonoo and Naval Tata.
- **1955:** Joins Cornell University (Ithaca, New York, USA) at the age of seventeen. Goes on to study mechanical engineering, then architecture, over a seven-year period.
- **1962:** Awarded the BSc degree in Architecture with Structural Engineering. Works with Jones & Emmons.
- **1962:** Joins the Tata Group as an assistant in Tata Industries Limited; later in the year, spends six months training at the Jamshedpur plant of TELCO (now called Tata Motors).
- **1963:** Moves to TISCO (now called Tata Steel) at its Jamshedpur facility for training.
- **1965:** Appointed technical officer in TISCO's engineering division.
- **1969:** Works as the Tata Group's resident representative in Australia.
- **1970:** Returns to India and joins Tata Consultancy Services, then a fledgling software, for a short stint.
- **1971:** Named director-in-charge of NELCO, an ailing electronics enterprise.
- **1974:** Joins the board of Tata Sons as a director.
- **1975:** Completes the Advanced Management Program at Harvard Business School.
- **1981:** Appointed chairman of Tata Industries Limited; begins the process of transforming it into a promoter of high-technology businesses.
- **1983:** Authors the Tata Strategic Plan.
- **1986:** Serves as chairman of Air India, the national carrier.
- **25 March 1991:** Takes over from J.R.D. Tata as chairman of Tata Sons and chairman of Tata Trusts.
- **1991:** Begins restructuring the Tata Group at a time when the liberalization of the Indian economy is underway.